



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ Classical Academy
School Website: <https://christclassicalacademy.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ Classical Academy (Tn 38024) presents a robust classical Christian program with clear alignment to the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Public materials from the school emphasize a Christ-centered, classical Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) delivered through Memoria Press resources, a Great-Books orientation, and explicit liturgical and communal practices (Focus time, chapel, Salt & Light, mission trips). The school also foregrounds formation over mere information, a strong partnership with families, and a living, virtuous faculty. Collectively, these signals place the school squarely in the CLASSICAL category across all six rubric categories, with particular strength in Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Evidence drawn from the school's public materials includes: explicit statements of a Christ-centered classical curriculum, the Trivium, Great-Books/Great Conversation framing, liturgical and prayer practices, and an active, partnership-oriented approach to parents and community. Positive signals such as "Christ-centered," "classical curriculum," "grammar–logic–rhetoric," "Great Books / Great Conversation," "Socratic seminar" (as described in higher-grade pedagogy), "Recitation and memory work," "Latin," and "Salt & Light" are repeatedly present. Countervailing negative signals are minimal; the school does not appear to rely on relativism, secular-skill framing, or purely project-based pedagogy in lieu of classical methods.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- The Religious & Metaphysical Foundations are well established (biblical/theological framing, liturgical practices, chapel, Focus times, daily prayer, and a stated faith basis).
 - Evidence includes: Salt & Light, Focus time, chapel services, Bible-centric rhythm, and a stated faith foundation.
 - Sources and keywords observed: Salt & Light program, Focus, chapel, Bible-centered worldview, Our Statement of Faith.
- The School Purpose & Goal centers on formation, virtue, and human flourishing, not mere job preparation.
 - Evidence includes: mission statements emphasizing formation, virtue, and the true/good/beautiful frame; the school's explicit aim to form thinking Christians who influence culture.
- The Curriculum centers on seven liberal arts through a Trivium/Quadrivium framework, with Great Books engagement and a biblically integrated liberal-arts approach.
 - Evidence includes: Memoria Press curriculum across grades, grammar–logic–rhetoric emphasis, Great Books orientation, historical breadth, Latin study.
- Pedagogy emphasizes both contemplative/restful elements and active, Socratic-level engagement in upper grades, with memorization and rhetoric training in later years.
 - Evidence includes: recitation/memorization in early grades; Socratic/colloquy-like approaches described for upper grades; upper-level rhetoric and public speaking activities.
- Faculty are presented as virtuous, living examples and mentors; the faculty is described as the living curriculum.
 - Evidence includes: explicit statements about faculty as living curriculum, commitment to virtue formation, and faculty profiles/board involvement.

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- Parents & Community are positioned as co-educators, with open campus policies and formal mechanisms for parent involvement and education about classical education.
 - Evidence includes: mission statements about joining Christian families, parent involvement emphasis, and open communication with families.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe liturgical and communal practices such as Focus, chapel, and Salt & Light, indicating a liturgical and communal approach integrated into the education process. The “Spiritual Formation at CCA” materials detail Focus, chapel services, and weekly Salt & Light activities.
 - The school presents a Christ-centered, Bible-grounded curriculum and worldview, with explicit non-denominational Christian framing and a statement of faith.
 - Our Mission and core values emphasize a Christian framing for education and character formation, aligning with theological and metaphysical foundations.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, chapel, worship, biblical worldview, sacred tradition, Logos, spiritual depth, faith, salvation.
 - Negative keywords (from the rubric) would be signals like secular relativism or value-neutral ethics; these are not evident in public materials.
 - The presence of liturgical rhythms, Bible-centered framing, and a stated faith basis are strong positive signals.
 - Cited: Salt & Light, Focus, Chapel (as liturgical/communal), Our Faith/Statement of Faith.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates explicit transcendental orientation through liturgical practices, theology-integrated culture, and a clear faith-based frame for education. This aligns with CLASSICAL expectations in the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations.
- Notes on rubric sources
 - Positive and Negative keyword lists come from the Six Essential Elements document (Positive Keywords, Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and the lexicon as codified in the Lexicon artifacts. See Six Essential Elements docx (Positive keywords) and the Lexicon (positive/negative terms).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school’s mission is framed as formation + virtue + wisdom, not solely job-readiness. The mission statement emphasizes forming students who become virtuous, wise, and able to influence culture, not just prepare for the workforce.
 - The public materials emphasize the true/good/beautiful pursuit and the telos of education, aligning with the classical aim of forming humans (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) rather than a narrow information-transfer goal. The explicit “three-fold mission” and core values frame education as formation in a Christian classical frame.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, love of learning, human flourishing, soul formation, moral imagination, contemplation, ethical cultivation, classical mission.
 - Negative signals (from rubric): focus on workforce readiness or job-readiness emphasis; not evident in public materials. Public statements emphasize formation and virtue over mere job prep.
 - The presence of a formation-centric mission is a strong CLASSICAL indicator.
- Why this rating

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- The school emphasizes formation and virtue, with classical aims and a sense of telos, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for School Purpose & Goal.
 - rubric sources
 - The mission statements and values appear in Our Mission / Our Purpose materials and the associated pages, including Our Mission and Our Purpose.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials reveal explicit use of a classical curriculum (Memoria Press Classical Core Curriculum deployed across grades). The Core Curriculum page states CCA uses a rigorous classical and Christian curriculum across grade levels with a strong classical emphasis.
 - The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium concepts, with explicit references to grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin, and classical literature. The Quick Facts/Academics sections list Latin, grammar, logic, rhetoric, and study of classic literature (Great Books) as part of the program.
 - Great Books / Great Conversation framing appears in multiple school materials and faculty pages, along with historical engagement and integration (e.g., classical literature lists, historical contexts).
 - The school emphasizes a total liberal-arts approach with integrated history, literature, philosophy, and sciences, plus an emphasis on Latin and classical literature.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, primary sources, Western civilization, Latin, classical literature, Memoria Press, primary sources, integration of disciplines, “great conversation.”
 - Negative signals: none evident in public materials (no heavy emphasis on social studies-over-history trends or exclusively project-based learning).
 - The presence of Memoria Press, Great Books framing, and Trivium elements strongly supports CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - Curriculum demonstrates a full alignment with classical education’s core content and structure: liberal arts emphasis, Great Books engagement, and memorization/recitation practices (as described in PK–12 materials).
- rubric sources
 - Six Essentials doc notes for Curriculum (great books, trivium/quadrivium, great conversation) and the public materials show these elements. See Six Essential Elements doc and the Memoria Press integration notes.
 - Additional corroboration from the classical lexicon and curriculum statements.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Early grades emphasize memorize/recitation and memory-work (grammar-stage pedagogy) with singing and ritualized daily practices (focus/repetition, memory verses). This aligns with the classical pedagogy of memory work and ritualized practice. Public materials describe daily recitation, memorization, and rehearsals; Latin vocabulary and grammar instruction begin in early grades.
 - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, and rhetoric training, with opportunities for students to give speeches and engage in rhetorical exercises (as described in the Core Curriculum and Classical Education sections).
 - The school emphasizes a combination of contemplative/scholé days and rigorous engagement (e.g., focus time, chapel, and worship-based formation alongside rigorous classical study).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Socratic, seminar, dialectic, recitation, chanting, memory work, rhetoric, canonical Great Books, learning through the Trivium, scholé, contemplation, wonder.

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- Negative signals: the rubric warns against exclusive project-based/experiential learning as the only method; in CCA, there is clear public evidence of memory work and Socratic-style activities, not solely experiential/project-based pedagogy.
 - The pedagogy shows a clear classical method mix: memory/recitation in lower grades; Socratic/seminar/rhetoric in upper grades.
 - Why this rating
 - Pedagogy harmonizes contemplative/Scholé elements with Socratic/seminar-based engagement and rhetoric training, which is characteristic of classical education.
 - rubric sources
 - Public materials describing lower-grade recitation/memory and upper-grade Socratic/seminar elements; also the explicit mention of rhetoric and public speaking in high school.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school presents faculty as mentors and living curriculum; the faculty are described as the core of the school and a model of virtue, skill, and knowledge. Pages about Our Faculty and Our Board emphasize faculty commitment to academic excellence and spiritual formation.
 - The public materials discuss faculty as role models, with a focus on virtue formation and partnership with students, and with a clear portrait of the teacher as a core element of the school's culture. Public pages describe faculty and staff as committed to academic excellence and spiritual formation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, faculty as core, virtue formation, collegiality, teacher as guide, portrait of teacher.
 - Negative signals: None evident in public materials (no signals of dysfunctional faculty culture or a focus on non-classical staff development).
 - The school's described faculty structure aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.
- Why this rating
 - The faculty description aligns with classical education norms (living curriculum, mentors, character formation, and a strong teacher-student relationship).
- rubric sources
 - Our Faculty and statements about faculty/board; the board narrative indicates a strong partnership with staff and mission alignment.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school positions parents as co-educators and partners with the school. The three-fold mission centers on “Joining Christian families in classically educating students,” indicating a formal parent-partner orientation. There is explicit emphasis on open campus policy and parental involvement; the school describes parent education and engagement resources (book studies, seminars) to help parents understand classical education.
 - The materials describe an emphasis on parental involvement, open communication, and a community-centric campus culture, with a focus on serving the community and a partnership with families.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school partnership, open campus, parental engagement, classical parent training, family involvement, living tradition in the family.
 - Negative signals: none evident in public materials (no customer-service rhetoric that reduces parents to customers or discourages involvement).
 - The presence of explicit parent partnership and education signals strong CLASSICAL.

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- Why this rating
 - The school emphasizes parents as co-educators and provides resources to educate parents about classical education, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parent & Community.
 - rubric sources
 - Our Mission/Our Purpose materials, the three-fold mission language emphasizing parental partnership, open campus, and parent education/engagement.

Aggregate assessment across categories

- The school demonstrates robust alignment with CLASSICAL across all six categories.
- Category-by-category notes consistently show Classical indicators (Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books orientation, liturgical rhythm, formation over information, public rhetoric surrounding virtue and wisdom, and strong parent/community partnerships).

What would move the needle

- For a SCHOOL classified as CLASSICAL, the rubric notes are primarily concerned with maintaining strength rather than large-scale reform. No major needle-moving changes are required to achieve CLASSICAL status.
- If there were any enhancements, they could include:
 - Further explicit articulation of Great Books selections across more grade bands (public-facing reading lists) to strengthen Great Conversation framing.
 - Expanded public documentation of Socratic discussion formats in middle/upper grades with sample prompts and rubrics.
- Note: These are minor enhancements and not required to reach CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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